

Groww, for your first ₹100

Redesigning Groww for India's 20–26 year-old, first-time investors

Live app: siddham-jain.github.io/growwz · Full evals: siddham-jain.github.io/growwz/evals.html

1. My take on the problem

Access is solved. Groww opens an account in minutes, and 56% of new NSE investors are now under 30. The problem is what happens *after* the account opens. A 22-year-old arrives with a small, irregular income, a finfluencer feed, and no idea which of 1,000+ funds is "right". The app greets them with tickers, red/green P&L and F&O one tap away.

So they either **freeze** (the account sits empty) or **gamble**: SEBI found 91% of individual F&O traders lost money in FY25, and 89% of under-30 traders lost. Both end in churn. The real job: **turn an anxious first-timer into someone with a lasting habit, and get them through their first market dip**. That's Groww's most valuable customer: joins at 22, stays 30 years.

Psychology I designed around: present bias → start from goals · lumpy income → flexible by default · loss aversion → calm by default · jargon shame → explain terms in place · dopamine apps → reward consistency · comparison → share %, never ₹.

2. In scope

- Onboarding → starter plan → first ₹100 (KYC assumed done)
- Goal-based Stashes, with the fund picked from the time horizon
- Payday split, %-of-payment splits for gigs, skip/pause, streaks with freezes
- Calm mode, Dip Coach and a neutral panic-sell check
- 60-second "Bytes" lessons and tap-to-decode jargon
- F&O reality check and cool-off, a capped "Spice pot", Squads

3. Out of scope

- KYC/account opening: already strong on Groww
- Live prices, payments, order routing: data is illustrative
- Loans/BNPL: debt works against the goal
- Crypto: unregulated in India
- F&O trading screens and paper trading: only the gate
- Hinglish (next step) and personalised advice (needs SEBI RIA)

4. The solution: goal-first, calm-by-default Groww

- Ask "what's it for?", not "what to buy?"** Each goal becomes a Stash. The time horizon picks the fund (Steady / Balanced / Growth) and says why. Money needed within 2 years never goes into equity; unaffordable goals become an honest first milestone.
- Fit the money people actually have.** ₹100 minimum. Salaries get a one-tap payday split; gig and pocket money get a % of each payment. Skip or pause anytime. Streaks count weeks invested, with freezes for broke months.
- Calm by default.** Home shows goal progress, not today's P&L. In a dip, Dip Coach explains what moved and what usually happens next.
- Learn without leaving.** Every jargon word is tappable, and story-style Bytes teach one idea in 60 seconds.
- Friction only where it protects.** F&O gets SEBI's loss data, a 3-question check, a one-time cool-off and a self-set loss limit; a capped Spice pot gives risk-seekers room.
- Social, without comparison.** Squads save for the same trip and share progress %, never rupees.

Why this works: it targets the two biggest churn points, the empty account and the first dip, and the first win (₹100 invested, a celebration, week 1 of a streak) lands within 12 taps.

Meme break 😊 (because it's for Gen Z)	
 Scrolling 1,000 funds looking for "the best one"	 Typing "MacBook fund" and letting the timeline pick
 Nifty -4%. Old me: "this is fine" 🤖🔥 (I sold)	 Dip Coach: "your Goa money barely moved." Actually fine.

5. How I tested it (evals)

What I checked	Result
Taps from opening the app to the first ₹100 invested	12
Automated evals (journeys, suitability logic, copy, accessibility)	41 / 41 pass
Cases of under-2-year money put in equity, across every horizon × risk profile	0
Unexplained jargon on decision screens / serious WCAG AA issues	0 / 0
Synthetic personas who would start this week (round 1 → round 2)	3/5 → 5/5

Two rounds of persona walkthroughs (student, first-jobber, freelancer, F&O trader, expert reviewer) drove 25+ fixes. Personas are synthetic, so results are directional; real user tests come next.

Measure: % of 20–26 sign-ups with ≥3 contributions by day 90; guardrails: F&O activation ↓, dip redemptions ↓, SIP bounces ↓.

Assumptions: KYC done; UPI AutoPay for mandates; illustrative data; stats from SEBI's FY25 F&O study and NSE.